Ryan Pegler

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EDUCATION

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign: Gies College of Business — *Expected Graduation: May 2026*
Bachelor of Science in Finance and Information Systems — **GPA: 3.60/4.00**
Bocconi University: Milan, Italy — *January 2025 – May 2025*
Exchange Program: Finance, Technology, and Management Courses

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

OpenField — **Chicago, Illinois**
Founder | CEO — *June 2025-Present*
- Built a platform connecting underrepresented athletes with businesses, securing NIL deals for income opportunities
- Manage 150+ client relationships, using data insights to match athletes with deals and expand partnership opportunities
- Oversee budgeting, forecasting, and payouts with 100% accuracy, ensuring timely payments for athletes and businesses

Prairie Road Partners — **Chicago, Illinois**
Investment Analyst Intern — *May 2024-August 2024*
- Executed deal sourcing and proprietary review for 1,000+ companies, leveraging Excel to identify acquisition targets
- Produced 30+ reports that drove strategic recommendations, directly shaping acquisition evaluations in the healthcare sector
- Delivered multi-sector market research, providing insights that informed investment decisions and deal prioritization

Illini Blockchain — **Champaign, Illinois**
Investment Analyst — *January 2024-November 2024*
- Analyzed blockchain assets and DeFi projects, identifying high-growth opportunities that guided investment discussions
- Presented 10+ research reports on emerging technologies, shaping understanding of market impacts and investment potential
- Completed intensive DeFi bootcamp, applying fundamentals to evaluate projects and their practical market applications

LEADERSHIP & INVOLVEMENT

Illinois Sports Consulting Agency — **Champaign, Illinois**
Consultant — *January 2024-May 2024*
- Conducted market analysis for a local sports startup and proposed strategies which projected 15% sales growth
- Collaborated on the company's app and business model, delivering data-driven recommendations to support company growth

HEDGE: Equities, Options, and Alternatives — **Champaign, Illinois**
Analyst — *January 2024-May 2024*
- Evaluated equities and derivatives data, applying valuation methods to assess real-world asset performance
- Engaged in weekly equity valuation and portfolio optimization sessions, strengthening technical market analysis skills

Investment Portfolio Organization — **Champaign, Illinois**
Investment Analyst — *September 2023-December 2023*
- Selected into premier finance organization to participate in weekly lessons involving professional development, accounting, investment strategies, and company valuation methodologies to enhance investment portfolio management skills
- Provided weekly market updates and a final stock pitch to faculty while managing a 2nd-ranked investment portfolio

Kappa Delta Rho - ETA Chapter — **Champaign, Illinois**
Treasurer | Social Chair — *September 2022-May 2024*
- Re-established chapter by recruiting 32 members while managing a $10,000+ annual budget and organizing 30+ events

Special Olympics Illinois — **Villa Park, Illinois**
Volunteer — *December 2021-February 2022*
- Supported 20+ athletes with developmental disabilities through coaching and officiating basketball games

PROJECTS

Oracle — **Champaign, Illinois**
Experiential Learning Consultant — *August 2025-Present*
- Apply AI solutions in Oracle's Siebel CRM to streamline interactions and improve efficiency for a Fortune 100 client

Fundamental — **Chicago, Illinois**
Developer — *July 2025*
- Developed an AI-powered investment tool to personalize stock selections, improving accessibility for 300+ retail investors

Upside — **Champaign, Illinois**
Developer | Data Analyst — *April 2024*
- Created a machine learning model utilizing 5 years of draft history to deliver data-driven insights for scouting and evaluation

SKILLS & INTERESTS

Key Skills: Market Research - Data Analysis - Microsoft Suite - Python - SQL - Financial Modeling - Leadership
Career Interests: Investment Management - Asset Management - Data Analytics - FinTech - Quantitative Finance
Other Interests: Basketball - Football - Soccer - Baseball - Golf - Travel - Movies - Coaching